

UX/UI DESIGN CONCEPT

Smart Interview Trainer

A clean, blue-gradient, SaaS-grade visual system for the interview practice platform — built for Next.js, React and Tailwind CSS.

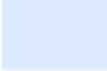
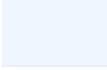
Prepared for: Smart Interview Trainer — Student Full-Stack Project
Stack: Next.js · React · Tailwind CSS · Express · PostgreSQL
Version: 1.0 · July 2026

02

Color Palette

A restrained palette: one blue family for brand and emphasis, a neutral slate scale for text and structure, and two muted semantic colors used sparingly for correct / missed feedback. No other hues are introduced.

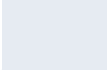
Brand Blue

SWA TCH	NAME	HEX	USAGE
	Brand 900	#1E3A8A	Deep gradient start, dark text-on-brand accents
	Brand 700	#1D4ED8	Primary buttons, active states, links, headings
	Brand 600	#2563EB	Gradient mid-point, icon accents
	Brand 500	#3B82F6	Gradient end, chart lines, focus rings
	Brand 100	#DBEAFE	Selected chip borders, subtle fills
	Brand 50	#EFF6FF	Hover backgrounds, selected cards, badges

Signature gradient

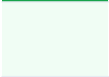
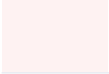
linear-gradient(135deg, #1E3A8A 0%, #1D4ED8 45%, #3B82F6 100%) — used on the dashboard hero, score rings, and primary CTA glow only.

Neutrals

SWA TCH	NAME	HEX	USAGE
	Ink 900	#0F172A	Primary text, headings
	Ink 700	#334155	Secondary text, body copy
	Ink 500	#64748B	Muted text, captions, placeholders
	Line	#E6EBF2	Borders, dividers, card outlines
	Surface	#FFFFFF	Page and card background

Semantic (used sparingly)

SWA TCH	NAME	HEX	USAGE
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	Success	#16A34A	Covered keywords, positive deltas, strengths
	Success BG	#F0FDF4	Success chip background
	Danger	#DC2626	Missed keywords, weakest category label
	Danger BG	#FEF2F2	Danger chip background

03

Typography

One typeface family keeps the build simple: **Inter** for everything, from the dashboard hero to the smallest caption. Hierarchy comes from size, weight, and color — not from mixing fonts.

ROLE	SPEC	EXAMPLE USE
Display / Hero	Inter, 26–34px, weight 700, letter-spacing –0.01em	Dashboard greeting, score hero headline
Page Title (H1)	Inter, 20–24px, weight 700	Page headers e.g. “Set up your interview”
Section Title (H2)	Inter, 15–17px, weight 700	“Recent Interviews”, “Question Feedback”
Body	Inter, 14px, weight 400–500, line-height 1.5	Question text, descriptions, card copy
Label / Eyebrow	Inter, 11px, weight 700, uppercase, tracked +0.08em	“QUESTION”, “INTERVIEW COMPLETE”
Caption / Muted	Inter, 12–13px, weight 400, color Ink 500	Timestamps, helper text, stat sub-labels

Font stack (no external font dependency required)

```
font-family: 'Inter', -apple-system, 'Segoe UI', sans-serif;
@import url('https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?family=Inter:wght@400;500;600;700&display=swap');
```

04

Component Style Rules

Cards. White fill, 1px Line border, 20px radius, soft 2-layer shadow (0 1px 2px rgba(15,23,42,.04), 0 8px 24px rgba(15,23,42,.06)). 20–24px internal padding.

Flat cards. Same as Card but 14px radius, no shadow — used for grids of small tiles (categories, answer-mode options) where many cards sit side by side.

Primary button. Gradient fill (Brand 700 → Brand 500), white text, 12px radius, medium shadow glow, weight 600. Reserved for one primary action per screen.

Secondary button. White fill, 1px Line border, Ink 700 text — used for Cancel, Skip, Review, and other non-primary actions.

Chips (single-select). 999px radius pill, 1px Line border. Selected state: Brand 600 border + Brand 50 fill + Brand 700 text, weight 600.

Segmented control. Light slate track (#F4F7FC), 12px radius container, individual 9px-radius pills. Selected segment: white background + soft shadow + Brand 700 text.

Progress bar. 8px height, 999px radius, Brand 100 track, Brand 700→500 gradient fill.

Score ring / hero badge. Circular, translucent white fill over the gradient hero, 3px semi-transparent white ring, bold percentage centered.

Feedback chips. Small pill, 999px radius. Covered = Success BG + Success text. Missed = Danger BG + Danger text. Always paired with a check or cross glyph.

Navbar. 72px height, white background, 1px bottom border, low-opacity blue wave pattern bleeding in from the right edge behind the nav tabs.

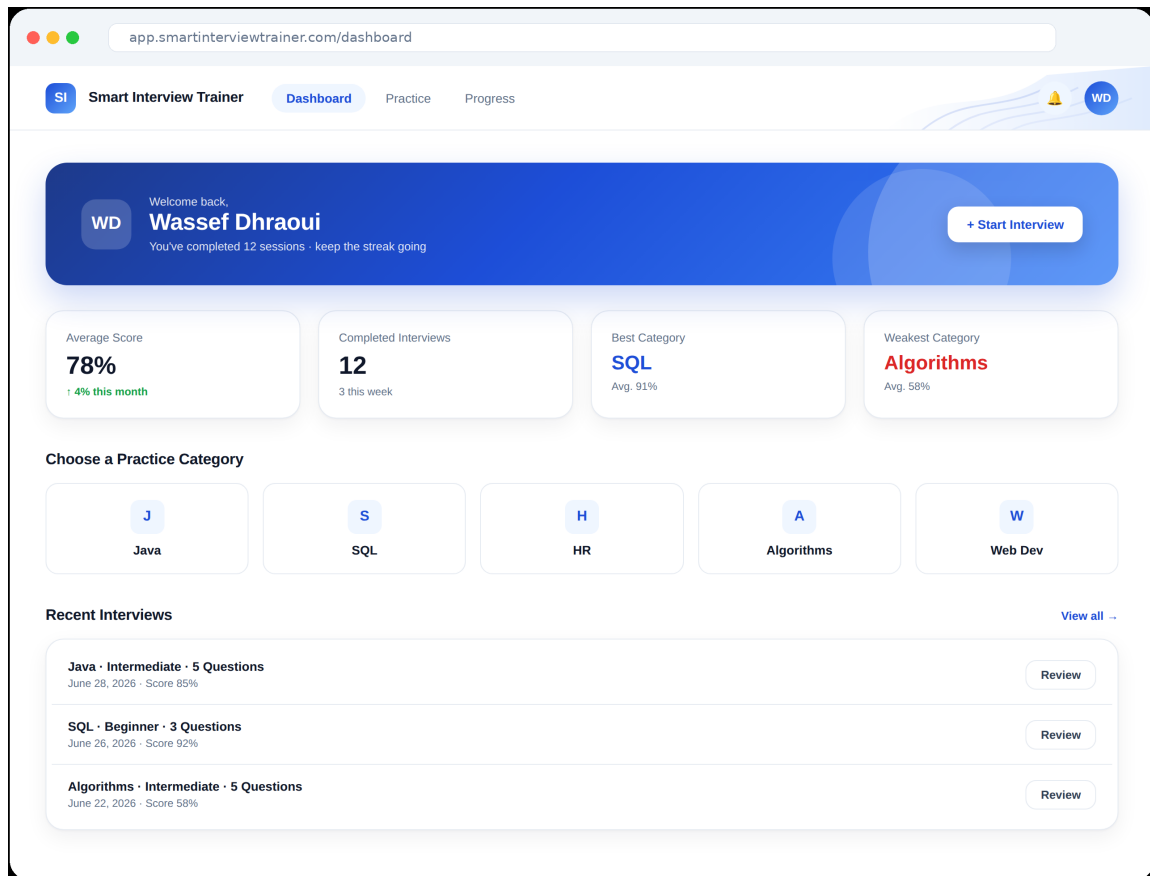
Layout Rules

Grid	12-column grid, 24px gutters, on a 1280px desktop canvas. Content max-widths vary by task: dashboard content spans the full canvas; focused tasks (setup, session, feedback) are capped narrower for readability.
Max widths	Dashboard / Progress: full width. Interview Setup / Session / Feedback: 720px, centered — mirrors the wireframe's "focus mode" intent.
Spacing scale	8pt baseline system: 8 / 12 / 16 / 20 / 24 / 32 / 36px. Section gaps use 28–36px; internal card padding uses 16–24px; inline gaps use 8–14px.
Navbar	Persistent, 72px tall, sticky top. Left: logo + nav tabs. Right: notification icon + avatar. Focus-mode pages (Setup, Session) trade tabs for a simple "← Cancel / Exit" control.
Hero placement	Only the Dashboard and Feedback pages use the full gradient hero block — first thing seen on arrival, immediately followed by white content.
Responsiveness	4-up KPI/category grids collapse to 2-up at tablet and 1-up (stacked) at mobile. Segmented controls and chips wrap onto multiple lines rather than shrinking text.

06

Dashboard

First screen after login. A full-width gradient hero greets the user by name and surfaces the single primary action (Start Interview). Below, four KPI cards give an at-a-glance read on performance, a category grid offers a fast way into practice, and a Recent Interviews list closes the loop back to past sessions.



Browser preview — Dashboard (desktop, 1280px canvas)

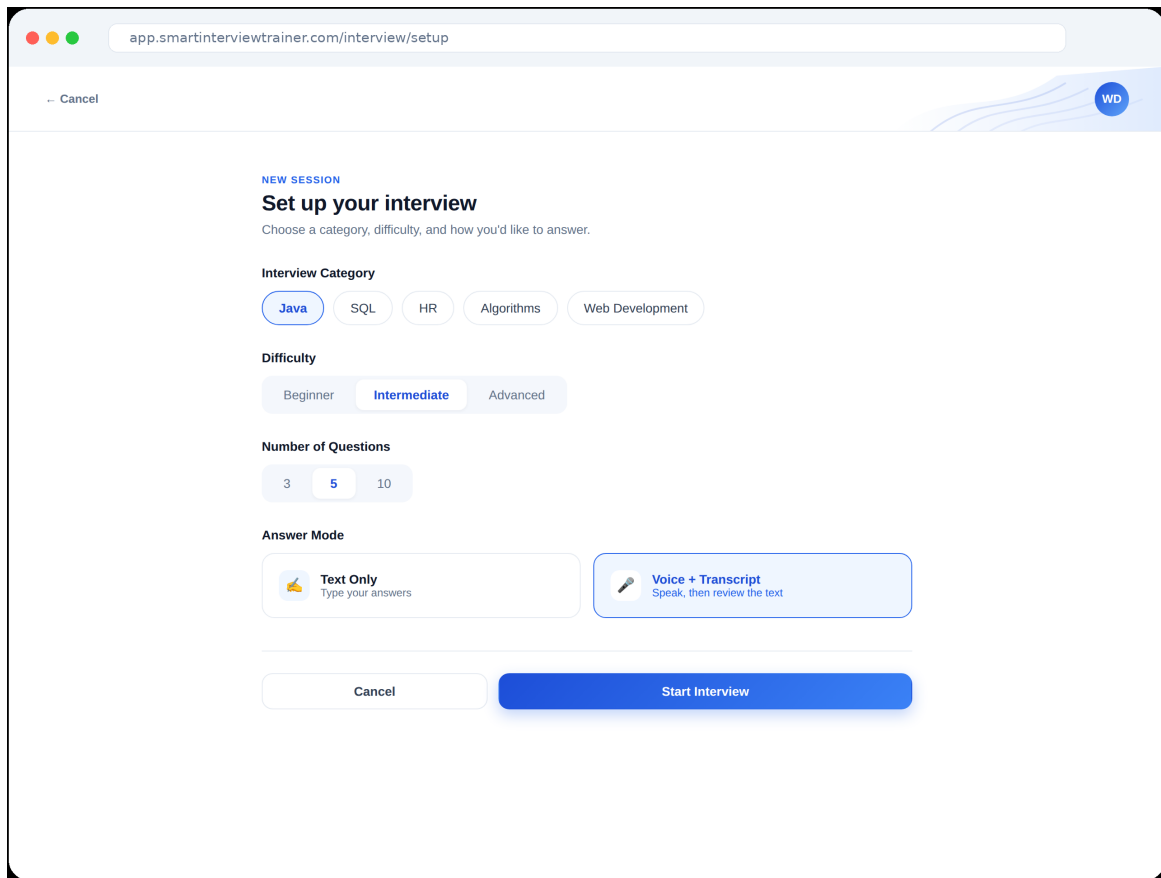
Suggested Tailwind classes

```
bg-white
bg-gradient-to-br from-blue-800 via-blue-700 to-blue-400
rounded-3xl shadow-xl
grid grid-cols-4 gap-5
rounded-2xl border border-slate-200 shadow-sm p-5
bg-blue-50 text-blue-700 rounded-full
text-emerald-600 text-xs font-semibold
```


07

Interview Setup

A focused, centered configuration form (max-width 720px) that walks the user through category, difficulty, question count, and answer mode before starting a session — matching the wireframe's single-column, top-to-bottom flow with sensible defaults pre-selected.



The image shows a browser window with the URL `app.smartinterviewtrainer.com/interview/setup`. The page has a light blue header with a "Cancel" button on the left and a "WD" logo on the right. The main content area is titled "NEW SESSION" and "Set up your interview" with the subtitle "Choose a category, difficulty, and how you'd like to answer." Below this, there are four sections: "Interview Category" with buttons for "Java" (selected), "SQL", "HR", "Algorithms", and "Web Development"; "Difficulty" with buttons for "Beginner", "Intermediate" (selected), and "Advanced"; "Number of Questions" with buttons for "3", "5" (selected), and "10"; and "Answer Mode" with two options: "Text Only" (selected, with a notepad icon) and "Voice + Transcript" (with a microphone icon). At the bottom, there are two buttons: "Cancel" and "Start Interview" (highlighted in blue).

Browser preview — Interview Setup (desktop, 1280px canvas)

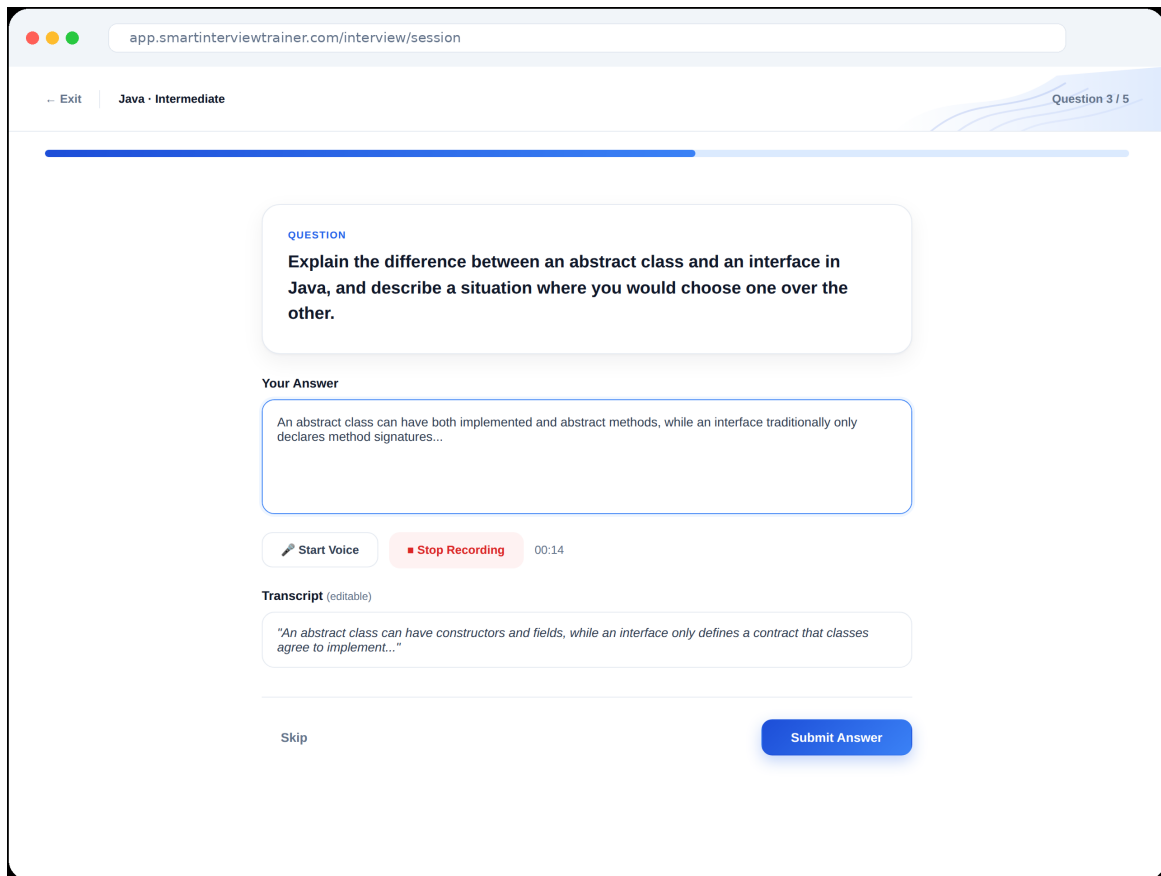
Suggested Tailwind classes

```
max-w-[720px] mx-auto
flex gap-2.5 flex-wrap
rounded-full border px-4.5 py-2.5
border-blue-600 bg-blue-50 text-blue-700 font-semibold
bg-slate-50 rounded-xl p-1 inline-flex
bg-white shadow-sm rounded-lg px-5 py-2 text-blue-700 font-semibold
grid grid-cols-2 gap-3.5
```

08

Interview Question Page

A distraction-free “exam mode” layout. A slim progress bar sits under the nav, the question is the single hero element on the page, and the answer textarea uses a visible blue focus ring. Voice controls and an editable transcript sit below as a secondary, optional path.



Browser preview — Interview Question Page (desktop, 1280px canvas)

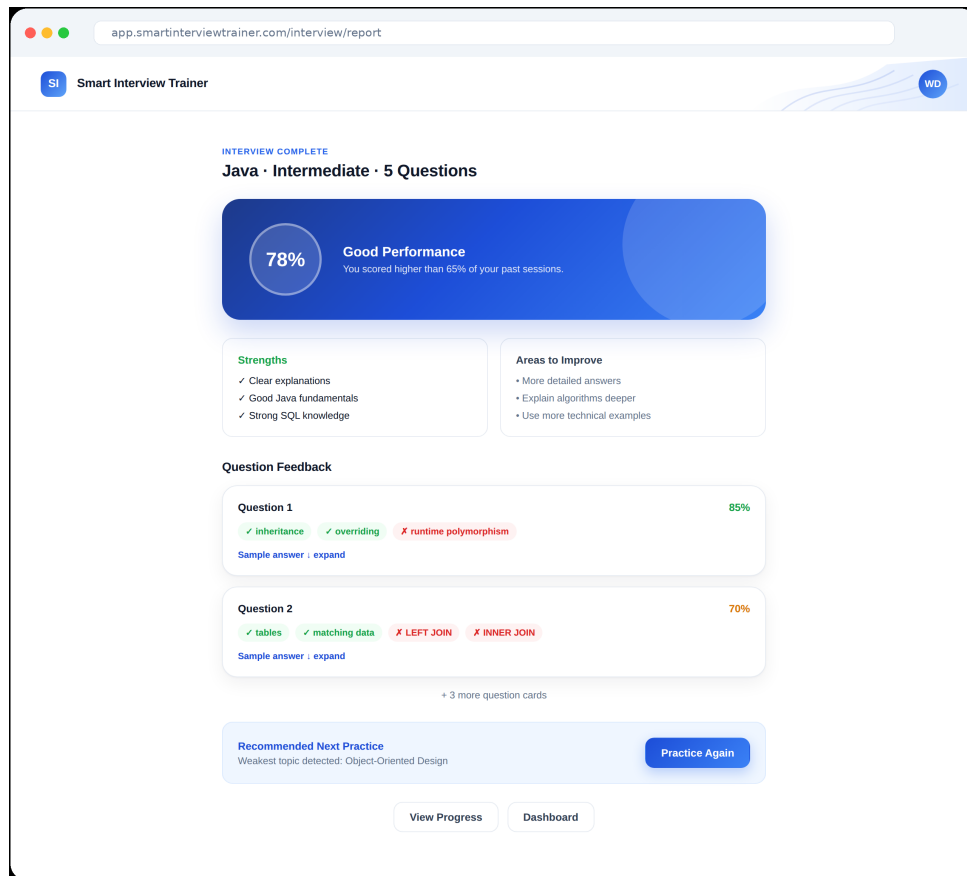
Suggested Tailwind classes

```
h-2 rounded-full bg-blue-100
bg-gradient-to-r from-blue-700 to-blue-500 h-full rounded-full
rounded-2xl border border-slate-200 shadow-sm p-7
focus:ring-2 focus:ring-blue-500/30 focus:border-blue-500 rounded-xl
italic text-sm text-slate-700 bg-white border rounded-xl p-4
```

09

Feedback Page

Delivered once as a single end-of-session report, mirroring the wireframe. A gradient score hero leads with the headline number, followed by Strengths / Areas to Improve, then per-question cards with covered/missed keyword chips. The sample answer is only exposed when a question scored below 100%.



Browser preview — Feedback Page (desktop, 1280px canvas)

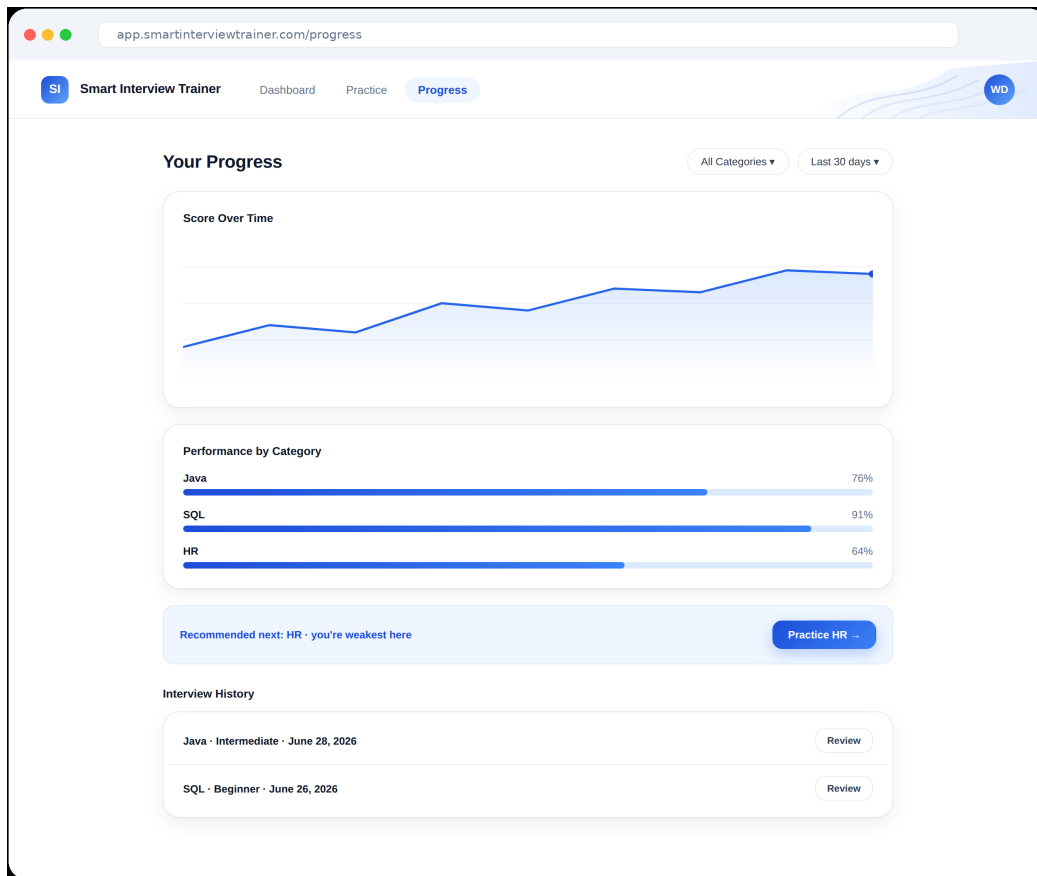
Suggested Tailwind classes

```
rounded-full bg-white/15 border-2 border-white/40 w-24 h-24 flex items-center justify-center
text-2xl font-bold
bg-emerald-50 text-emerald-600 rounded-full px-2.5 py-1 text-xs font-semibold
bg-red-50 text-red-600 rounded-full px-2.5 py-1 text-xs font-semibold
bg-blue-50 border border-blue-100 rounded-2xl p-5 flex items-center justify-between
```

10

Progress Page

An analytics view: a score-over-time area chart, per-category progress bars, a recommendation band, and interview history — matching the wireframe's filter bar → chart → bars → recommendation → history vertical order.



Browser preview — Progress Page (desktop, 1280px canvas)

Suggested Tailwind classes

```
max-w-[900px] mx-auto
rounded-2xl border shadow-sm p-6
h-2 rounded-full bg-blue-100
bg-gradient-to-r from-blue-700 to-blue-500 h-full rounded-full
bg-blue-50 border border-blue-100 rounded-xl px-5 py-4 flex items-center justify-between
```

11

Implementation Notes

- **Tailwind config.** Extend the theme with the brand scale above as `colors.brand` (50 / 100 / 500 / 600 / 700 / 900) so gradients and states reference `brand-700` / `brand-500` instead of raw hex values.
- **Reusable components.** Build five shared React components early: `Card`, `Chip`, `SegmentedControl`, `ProgressBar`, and `GradientHero`. Every page in this document is composed almost entirely from these five.
- **Gradient discipline.** Keep the gradient to at most one element per screen (hero or score ring). Applying it more broadly will dilute the hierarchy this system is built to create.
- **Accessibility.** Maintain 4.5:1 contrast for body text on white (`Ink 700` / `Ink 900` already pass). White text on the gradient hero passes at Brand 700 and darker — avoid placing white text over the lightest part of the gradient (Brand 400/500).
- **Voice-to-text fallback.** On the Interview Session page, if microphone permission is denied, hide the voice control cluster and auto-focus the textarea — no error state needed, per the PRD's stated fallback.

This document accompanies five ready HTML preview files (one per page) built with plain, dependency-free CSS matching every token defined above — delivered alongside this PDF for direct reference while translating each screen into Tailwind/React components.